way that one player moves the marker stones in the game *weiqi* (Go) in order to encircle the opponent. It is argued that China, through investments and other forms of cooperation with Indian Ocean littoral states, seeks to strengthen its long-term position vis-à-vis India.[75] China's growing influence and presence in South Asia and in the Indian Ocean Region have gained momentum since 2013, with the BRI. It is open for debate whether the BRI is driven by economic or geopolitical motives, but it certainly has geopolitical implications.[76] Over the last decade, China has systematically engaged with countries in India's neighbourhood, such as Nepal, Sri Lanka, Bangladesh, and the Maldives, through economic and military aid. The BRI has also pushed to the fore the central role of the China–Pakistan Economic Corridor, which will entail Chinese investments worth $60 billion in infrastructure and power projects in Pakistan. The CPEC's passing through India-claimed, Pakistan-occupied Kashmir has led to repeated Indian protests.[77] In much the same way that China fears US encirclement, India fears Chinese encirclement.

The current government has placed India's neighbourhood as a top foreign policy priority, with Modi famously inviting the heads of the SAARC countries to his swearing-in ceremony in May 2014. In addition, several of Modi's first international visits were to neighbouring countries such as Bhutan, Nepal, and Myanmar. Myanmar provides an interesting example of how India's relationship with its neighbours has changed in light of increasing Chinese influence. India was one of the fiercest critics of the military regime in Myanmar following the 1988 pro-democracy demonstrations, and Yangon soon built a close relationship with Beijing. India opted for a gradual policy of engagement; however, for India, matching China's leverage in Myanmar has proved challenging. Nevertheless, despite recent research aiming to "deconstruct" the notion of a "Sino-